unhappiness over the Iran affair, wanted to see me to lay down an ultimatum: Either I fire John Poindexter, or George would quit. I invited George and Don to the living quarters at the White House that evening to discuss the situation. George, as I'd been warned, was extremely upset and urged me to fire Poindexter. He said Poindexter had misled me and others in the administration about the weapons shipments. Although George didn't threaten to quit, I wrote in the diary: "I fear he may be getting ready to say, 'either someone else is fired or I quit.' I've called a Monday afternoon meeting of him and Don, me and Cap W., Bill Casey, John P. and the VP to get everything about the Iran effort out on the table."

I respected George Shultz as a man of the highest integrity. He made me wonder if there were things about the Iranian initiative I didn't know about. So, early the next day, I asked Attorney General Ed Meese to come to the White House and I told him about George's remarks.

Ed said some of his people in the Justice Department had already found inconsistencies in some of the things we had been saying, based on Poindexter's remarks, about the weapon shipments to Iran. I asked him to conduct an immediate and thorough review of the events to find out exactly what had happened. It was Friday; I asked him to spend the weekend looking into the matter, and to report to me on Monday.

Nancy and I spent the weekend at Camp David, where the weather was crisp and very cold. I spent a good part of Saturday and Sunday watching myself being pilloried on television because of the Iran initiative.

On Monday morning, the Iran affair was the subject of a two-hour meeting in the Situation Room. Afterward, I wrote in my diary: "George Shultz is still stubborn that we shouldn't have sold the arms to Iran. I gave him an argument. All in all, we got everything out on the table."